

# Begin Your Programming Journey with **Go!**



This article is an introduction to Go, an open source programming language that makes it easy to build simple, reliable and efficient software.

**G**o is a small and efficient programming language that supports pointers without missing features available in high-level languages with a C-like spirit. It also has a large and wide-ranging standard library.

Go started as an internal Google project in 2007 to help Google handle big programs developed by big teams. In November 2009, Go went public, under a liberal open source licence. So, are you ready to program in Go?

## Installing Go

Your Linux/UNIX distribution probably includes a ready-to-install Go package, so go ahead and install it. In order to find out the version of Go you are using, type the following command:

```
$ go version
go version go1.1 darwin/amd64
```

The output shows that I am using Go version 1.1 which,

at the time of writing this article, is the latest. Now, it is time to see some Go code. The Go version of the *Hello World* program is the following:

```
package main
import "fmt"

func main() {
    fmt.Println("Hello, world!")
}
```

In order to compile and run the *hello.go* file, you should run the following command:

```
$ go run hello.go
Hello, world!
```

Please note that in Go, due to the absence of the